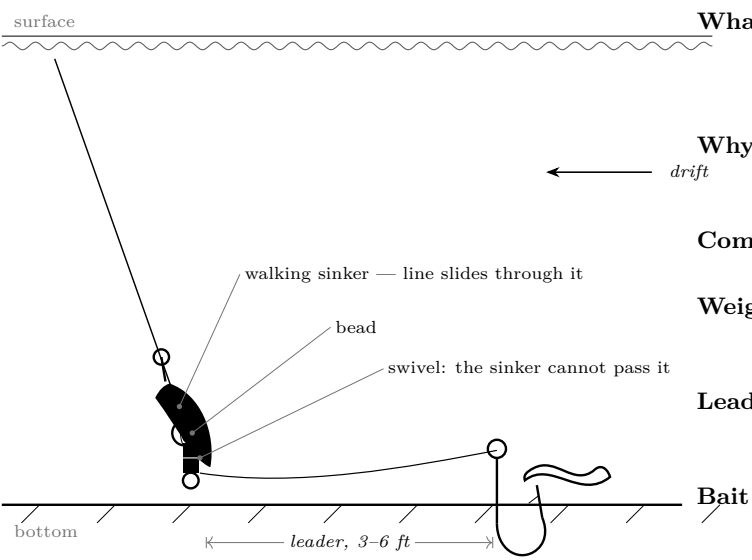


Lindy Rig

Drag live bait along the bottom and let the fish take line

The walleye rig — also called a slip-sinker or live-bait rig



What it does The sinker drags the bottom; the line slides *through* it. When a fish picks up the bait it feels no weight at all, so it keeps moving instead of dropping the bait.

Why it matters A cold-water walleye mouths a bait and spits anything that resists. This rig removes the resistance.

Components Walking or egg sinker, bead, barrel swivel, 3–6 ft leader, single hook.

Weight 1/4 oz to 20 ft, 3/8 oz to 30 ft, 1/2 oz deeper or in wind. Use the lightest that keeps bottom contact.

Leader Long and light in Pine Lake’s clear water — 6 ft of 6 lb fluorocarbon. Shorter and heavier on North Lake.

Bait Leech, half a nightcrawler, or a lively minnow hooked through the lips.

Build it

1. Thread the **sinker** onto the main line, narrow end first, so the line runs freely through it.
2. Add a **bead** to protect the knot from the sinker.
3. Tie the main line to one eye of a **barrel swivel**. The swivel is the stop: the sinker rides above it and cannot reach the hook.
4. Tie the **leader** to the other eye, then the **hook** to the leader.

Fish it

Speed Slower than feels right. Drift with the wind or use the electric motor at a crawl — roughly the speed you would walk a dog that keeps stopping.

Contact You must feel the sinker ticking bottom. If you cannot, add weight; if it is plowing, take weight off.

The take You will feel weight, or a tap, or simply nothing where there was bottom a moment ago. **Do not set the hook.**

Feed it Open the bail or drop the rod tip and give the fish line for a slow count of five to ten. The fish is turning the bait to swallow it head first.

Then set Close the bail, reel until the line comes tight, and sweep the rod. No snap.

Follow the contour Keep the boat on one depth line. A walleye break is a line, not a spot.

When to use it

Pine Lake spots **3** and **8**, North Lake spot **3**, in 18–35 ft. It is the highest-percentage way to catch a walleye on either lake, and it doubles as a smallmouth and perch rig. It is also the rig that most rewards patience: the whole thing depends on giving line to a fish that has not yet decided to keep your bait.

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